



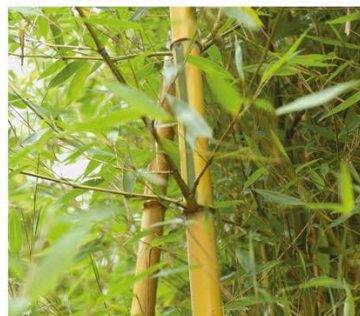
TREE SMALL

Malus domestica

APPLE TREE Plant a dessert apple tree for its delicious sweet fruits and pretty spring blossom. Opt for one on a dwarfing rootstock, such as M9, for a small garden. Varieties include 'Cox's Orange Pippin' (above), with sweet red apples.

↕ 25ft (8m)

☀️ ☀️ Z4–8



BAMBOO LARGE

Phyllostachys aureosulcata f. spectabilis

YELLOW GROOVE BAMBOO This bamboo has tall upright canes clothed in soft green leaves. It lends the garden a junglelike appearance, and can be used to provide shelter and privacy to an outdoor play area.

↕ 20ft (6m) ↔ indefinite

☀️ ☀️ ☀️ Z5–11



PERENNIAL MEDIUM

Platycodon grandiflorus

BALLOON FLOWER The purple-blue flowers of this perennial open from balloonlike buds throughout early fall, creating beautiful displays in containers filled with soil-based potting mix. Add a frill of violas around the edge to inject more color.

↕ 24in (60cm) ↔ 18in (45cm)

☀️ ☀️ Z3–8



TREE SMALL

Prunus x subhirtella 'Pendula'

HIGAN CHERRY This weeping cherry has pink buds that open into scented white spring flowers. The spreading branches create a private play space for children. Its fall color also adds to its decorative value.

↕ 25ft (8m)

☀️ ☀️ Z6–8



TREE SMALL

Pyrus salicifolia 'Pendula'

WILLOWLEAF PEAR This small tree creates a skirt of weeping stems studded with narrow silvery green leaves, beneath which children can hide. Creamy white spring flowers are followed by inedible brown fruits.

↕ 25ft (8m) ↔ 20ft (6m)

☀️ ☀️ Z4–7



TREE SMALL

Salix caprea 'Pendula'

PUSSY WILLOW This large deciduous shrub or small tree produces arching stems that develop soft furry catkins in late winter, which are loved by children. The dark green leaves follow in spring. Considered invasive in some areas.

↕ 6ft (2m)

☀️ ☀️ Z6–8



PERENNIAL SMALL

Sempervivum arachnoideum

COBWEB HOUSELEEK This low-growing evergreen perennial has rosettes of fleshy green leaves covered with fine white hairs that resemble cobwebs. Children can easily grow it in containers and raised beds, where it will form neat mounded clumps.

↕ 5in (12cm) ↔ 4in (10cm) or more

☀️ ☀️ Z5–8



ANNUAL/BIENNIAL SMALL

Solanum lycopersicum

BUSH TOMATO Tomato plants help to teach children how to care for plants, and reward even basic care with tasty summer fruits. Bush varieties that grow outside are the best choices, particularly dwarf types for patio containers.

↕ 18in (45cm)

☀️ ☀️



PERENNIAL SMALL

Stachys byzantina

LAMB'S EARS This perennial produces downy silver-gray foliage and spikes of small mauve-pink flowers in summer. A tough plant with soft tactile leaves, it is perfect for edging a bed in a sunny family garden.

↕ 15in (38cm) ↔ 24in (60cm)

☀️ ☀️ Z4–8



ANNUAL/BIENNIAL SMALL

Tropaeolum majus Alaska Series

NASTURTIUM A bushy annual with round cream-splashed dark green leaves and red and yellow trumpet-shaped summer to early fall blooms. Grow it in tall pots for children to pick the edible leaves and flowers.

↕ 12in (30cm) ↔ 18in (45cm)

☀️ ☀️



SHRUB MEDIUM

Vaccinium corymbosum

HIGHBUSH BLUEBERRY This easy-to-grow soft fruit bush bears delicious sweet-tasting blue-black fruits in summer. Plant in a large pot of acidic soil mix in a sunny spot. Children will love the berries, which are packed with healthy vitamins.

↕ 5ft (1.5m)

☀️ ☀️ ☀️ Z3–7

OTHER SUGGESTIONS

Annuals

Antirrhinum Bells Series • *Cucurbita pepo* 'Jack Be Little' • *Helianthus annuus* 'American Giant' (N)

Perennials and climbers

Alocasia 'Borneo Giant' • *Acmella oleracea* • *Cosmos atrosanguineus* (N) • *Geranium* 'Johnson's Blue' • *Ipomoea lobata* (N) • *Muhlenbergia capillaris* (N) • *Selaginella kraussiana* • *Sedum spectabile*

Shrubs and bamboos

Choisya 'Aztec Pearl' • *Choisya ternata* (N) • *Fargesia murielae* • *Lavandula angustifolia*

Shrubs and bamboos

Cercidiphyllum japonicum f. *pendulum* • *Sassafras albidum* (N) • *Sequoiadendron giganteum* 'Pendulum' (N)